

CIVCITY
ROME

 Rating: 7/10
 Developer: Firefly Studios
 Publisher: 2K Games
 Distributor: E-Xpress Interactive
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The City's There; Where's The Civ?

When we first heard of *CivCity: Rome*—the city building strategy game that takes its inspiration from Sid Meier's *Civilization* (Civ)—there were only good things expected. After all, with such impressive pedigree, how much could go wrong? No, this isn't one of those corny reviews where we say "plenty"; strictly speaking, there's nothing wrong with *CivCity Rome*, and therein lie its faults. Confused yet?

In *CivCity: Rome*, you'll be building cities all over Italy and generally doing your bit for the glory of Rome by feeding it resources and researching new technologies. On the surface, it looks like Firefly Studios took *Caesar III*, fixed some of the minor annoyances we had with that superb game, added a couple of new in-game features, and threw it back at us before *Caesar IV* could come out. Not that we're complaining. You can now track the location of every resident of every house—where he works, what he's doing and what he thinks of your city. You can even peek into his

home, though you don't get to know much from that.

Playing the game is dead easy—there are no manuals to read before starting. An in-game voice guides you through, and difficulty isn't that high either. An interesting addition is the *Civilopedia*, which gives you a wide and comprehensive look into the lives of the ancient Romans. If you're looking for links to the *Civilization* series, though, a microscope would help. None but the series' most hardcore fans can find the connections (save the researching technologies and *Civilopedia* bits), and even then they don't make much of a difference.

Big picture: like I said, there's really nothing wrong with the game. But then again, there's nothing about that jumps out and screams "Play me!". If you're a first-timer to the genre, it's brilliant, and if you're returning, you'd lose very little if you gave it a miss.

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